



PARTNER GUIDE

Joining the IMWIRSA Global Maritime Welfare Network

A practical guide for seafarers' centres, missions
and welfare organisations considering partnership
with IMWIRSA.

About IMWIRSA

IMWIRSA — the International Maritime Welfare Innovation Research and Support Association — is an independent, non-profit international initiative headquartered in Tallinn, Estonia. We bring together researchers, seafarers' centres, maritime unions, port authorities and technology partners around a single goal: making seafarer welfare visible, evidence-based and accessible everywhere a ship calls.

We don't replace the seafarers' centres, missions and chaplaincies that have supported sailors for generations — we connect them. Every partner keeps its name, its funding and its independence; IMWIRSA provides the shared digital layer, research and coordination that lets the whole network work as one.



Research-led

Grounded in peer-reviewed evidence and real seafarer data.



Partnership-based

We grow through voluntary partnership, not replacement.



Technology-enabled

MWApp turns good intentions into something usable.

THE MODEL

Four Components of the Platform

1. Living Port Card

Structured, always-current information about the port: transport, seafarers' centre, shops, medical, safety — maintained by a local coordinator.

2. Port Welfare Manager (PWM)

A real person from your centre who keeps the port card current through a simple Telegram bot — no new software to learn.

3. Volunteer Support Line

A live, anonymous chat available 24/7 for seafarers who need to talk to someone — from directions to a crisis.

4. Wellness Recovery Zone

A partnership with local specialists — massage, physiotherapy, counselling — offering a short, judgement-free window of relief near the centre.

What You Keep, What You Gain

Partnership with IMWIRSA is additive. Your centre's identity, governance and funding remain entirely your own.

YOU KEEP

Full independence

- Your name, history and identity
- Your own management and funding
- Full organisational independence
- Freedom to work with other networks
- Right to leave the partnership any time

YOU GAIN

A global network

- International visibility to seafarers in their own language
- More visitors through better accessibility
- Best-practice exchange across the network
- Free MWApp management tools and analytics
- Support to establish a Wellness Recovery Zone

Recognition for Your Port Welfare Manager

IMWIRSA offers a flexible recognition model that your organisation and PWM choose together:

- **Status & recognition** — official certificate, a named page on the platform, reference letter, private PWM community access.
- **Financial support** — where budget allows, a monthly stipend (€50–150) and covered connectivity costs.
- **Organisational growth** — free promotion, access to grant programmes, staff training, priority feature access.

NO SURPRISES

Conditions of Joining the Pilot

NOT REQUIRED

No hidden costs

- No mandatory financial contribution
- No restructuring your organisation
- No change to your charter or governance
- No exclusivity — keep working with other networks
- No new software or hardware to buy

WHAT'S NEEDED

Just one committed person

- One Port Welfare Manager from your centre
- 15-20 minutes a week to keep the port card current
- Telegram on the coordinator's phone
- A 30-minute introductory call, online
- Willingness to collaborate — fully voluntary participation

How Partnership Starts

01

Get in touch

We reply within 24 hours.

02

Introductory call

30-45 min online, within two weeks.

03

Centre profile

Added to the international registry.

04

Pilot begins

Platform access, PWM appointed, live in your port.

Ready to start the conversation?

Email: info@imwirsas.org

Web: imwirsas.org/partners.html

Tallinn, Estonia